

CYBER SECURITY
INTERNSHIP

SEPTEMBER 2028

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

Phishing attacks are one of the most common forms of cybercrime used to steal sensitive information such as passwords, banking credentials, OTPs, and personal data. Cybercriminals often disguise themselves as trusted organizations through fake emails, messages, or websites to deceive users into revealing confidential information.

This report focuses on identifying phishing indicators in suspicious emails and messages by analyzing sender details, malicious links, urgent language, and social engineering techniques. The purpose of this task is to improve cybersecurity awareness and help users recognize and prevent phishing attacks effectively.

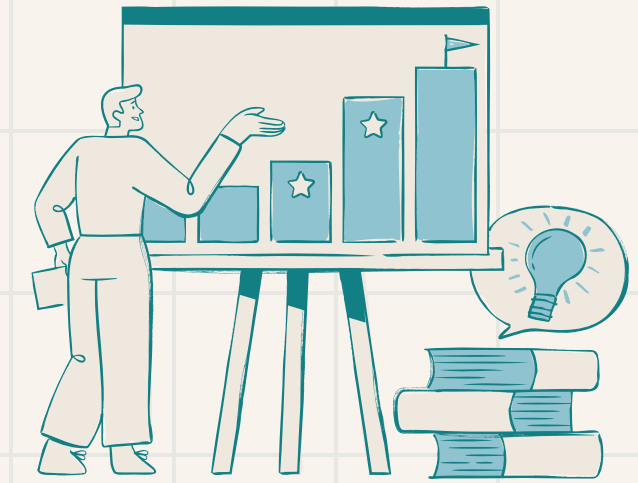




Objectives

- To analyze and identify phishing emails and suspicious messages
- To classify emails as Legitimate, Suspicious, or Phishing
- To understand common phishing techniques used by attackers
- To improve cybersecurity awareness and safe email practices
- To identify malicious indicators such as fake domains, spoofed senders, and suspicious links
- To provide prevention guidelines for protecting users from phishing attacks

TOOLS USED



- Web Browser

Used to access phishing awareness platforms and analyze email samples.

- Google Phishing Quiz

Used for identifying phishing and legitimate email examples through practical analysis.

- Microsoft Word / Canva

Used for preparing and designing the phishing analysis report professionally.

- Screenshot Tool

Used to capture phishing examples, results, and analysis findings for documentation.

- GitHub

Used for storing, managing, and submitting the project repository publicly.

- Internet Connection

Used to access online phishing simulation platforms and cybersecurity resources.



EMAIL ANALYSIS

Sample 1 – Fake Verification Code Message

- **Classification**

Phishing

- **Indicators Identified**

- Requests the user to share a verification/OTP code
- Uses urgent language to create panic
- Attempts to trick the user into bypassing account security
- Suspicious message requesting confidential authentication information

- **Risk Level**

High

- **Analysis**

This message is a phishing attempt designed to steal a Google verification code from the user. Cybercriminals often use social engineering techniques to manipulate users into sharing OTPs or authentication codes. Legitimate companies and services never ask users to share verification codes through messages or emails.

- **Possible Threat**

- Unauthorized account access
- Identity theft
- Account takeover
- Data compromise

- **Prevention Guidelines**

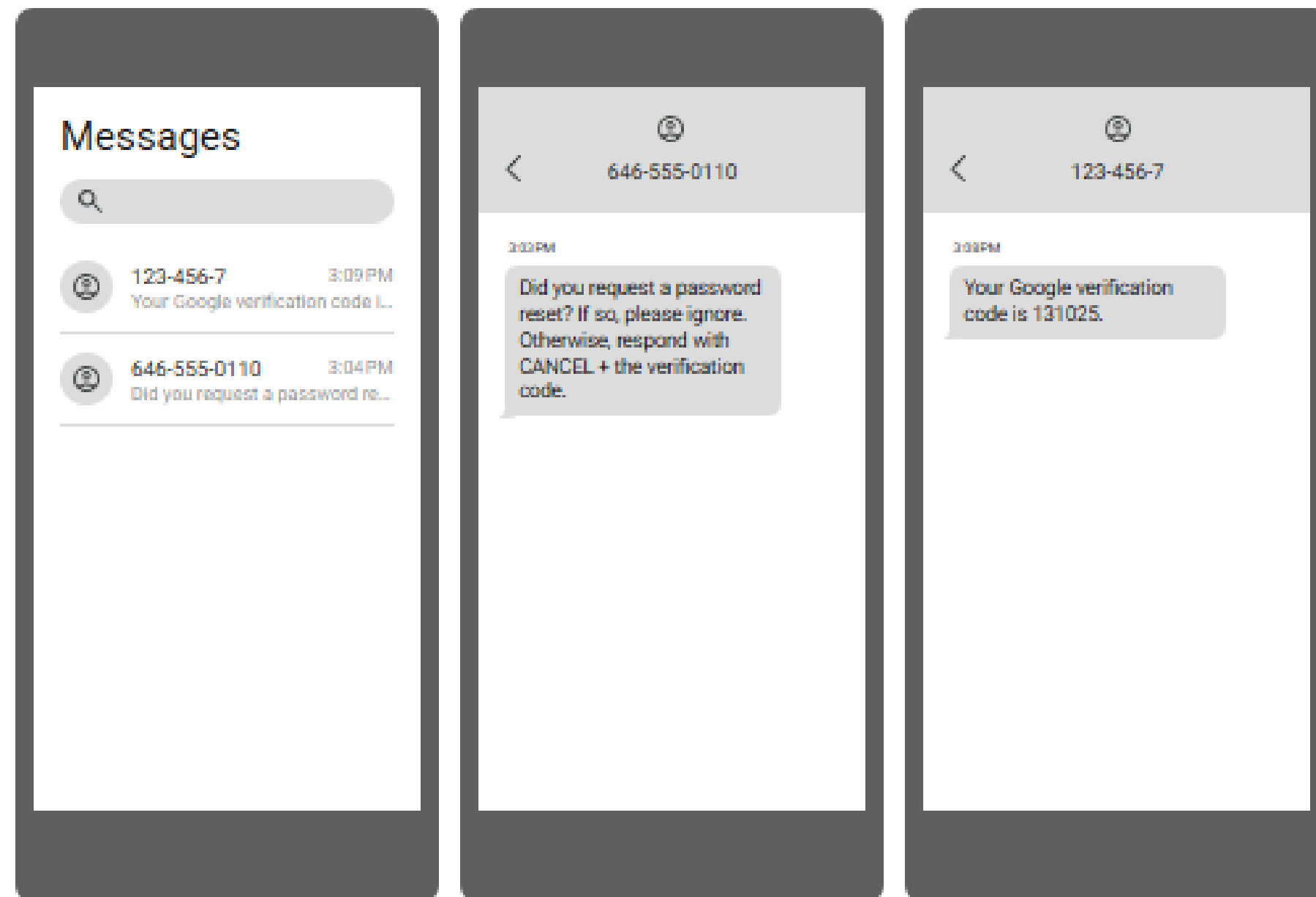
- Never share OTP or verification codes with anyone
- Verify requests only through official company channels
- Ignore suspicious authentication requests
- Enable two-factor authentication securely
- Report phishing messages immediately

Correct! You got it! This is a phish.

Never share a 2-Step code outside of a real-time verification process you initiated, such as a website login or while on the phone with your bank.

When possible, you should also consider unphishable options such as Passkeys or using a phone as a security key.

Show me



Sample 2 – Dropbox Storage Upgrade Email

- **Classification**

Legitimate

- **Indicators Identified**

- Sender domain is associated with Dropbox
- Uses a secure HTTPS link
- Professional email formatting and branding
- No suspicious urgency or threat
- Clear and informative communication about storage usage

- **Risk Level**

Low

- **Analysis**

This email is a legitimate communication from Dropbox regarding account storage capacity. The sender address and secure link indicate that the email originates from an official source. The message uses professional formatting, proper branding, and does not attempt to manipulate the user through fear or urgency. The content is informational and related to normal account management services

- **Possible Threats**

- No immediate phishing indicators detected
- Low security risk when accessed carefully through official channels

- **Prevention Guidelines**

- Always verify sender domains before clicking links
- Ensure links use secure HTTPS connections
- Access accounts through official websites when uncertain
- Avoid entering credentials on unfamiliar pages
- Maintain strong account passwords and security settings

Correct! This is legitimate.

This is a legitimate Dropbox communication. The sender is “dropboxmail.com,” which is unusual but legitimate, and the URL is a secure link (https) to “dropbox.com.”

Show me



Dropbox <no-reply@dropboxmail.com>
to me ▼

7:34PM



Hi,

Your Dropbox is full and is no longer syncing files. New files added to your Dropbox folder won't be accessible on your other devices and won't be backed up online.

Upgrade your Dropbox today and get 1 TB (1,000 GB) of space and powerful sharing features.

Upgrade your Dropbox

For other ways to get more space, visit our [Get More Space](#) page.

Happy Dropboxing!

- The Dropbox Team

P.S. If you need the biggest plan we've got, check out [Dropbox for Business](#).

Sample 3 – Fake Google Security Alert Email

- **Classification**

Phishing

- **Indicators Identified**

- Uses a fake look-alike domain
- Sender email is not from an official Google domain
- Creates fear by claiming suspicious account activity
- Urges the user to change the password immediately

- **Risk Level**

High

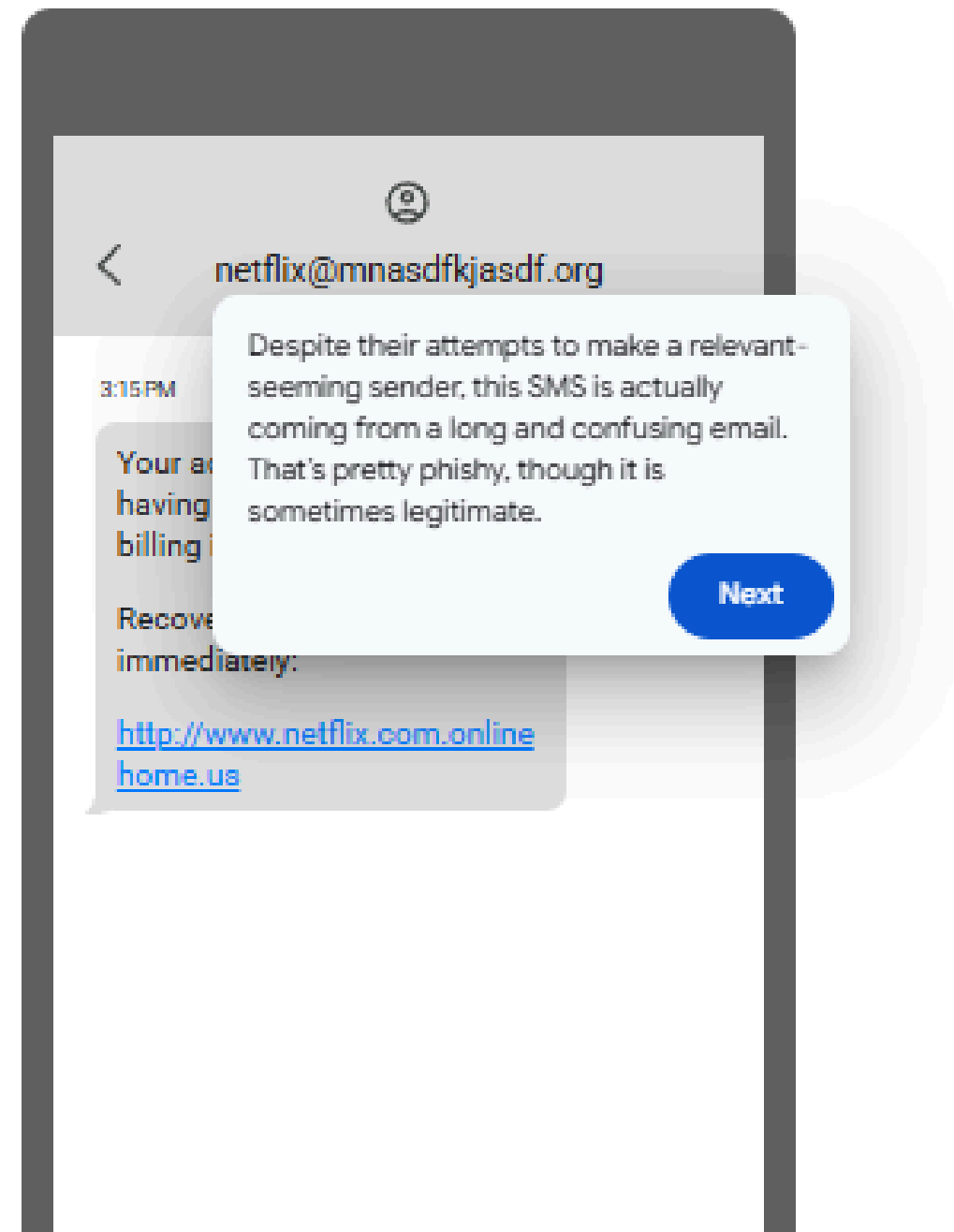
- **Analysis**

This email is a phishing attempt that imitates a Google security alert. Attackers commonly use fake domains and urgent warning messages to trick users into clicking malicious links or entering login credentials on fake websites. The email attempts to create panic and manipulate the user into acting without verifying the authenticity of the message.

Correct! Phew, binge on!

You must have spotted the clever look-alike URL and that the SMS came from an email address, not a phone number. If you ever have any doubts about a notification, don't click the link; visit the site the way you normally do and get in touch with them that way.

Show me



Sample 4 — Fake Google Account Sign-In Alert

- **Classification**

Phishing

- **Indicators Identified**

Uses a fake look-alike sender domain:

no-reply@google.support

- - Pretends to be an official Google security notification
 - Creates fear by claiming someone tried to access the account
 - Encourages immediate password change
 - Uses a misleading URL and suspicious sender address
 - Attempts to manipulate the user into clicking malicious links

- **Risk Level**

High

- **Analysis**

- This email is a phishing attempt that imitates a Google account security alert. The attacker uses a look-alike domain to make the message appear trustworthy. The email creates urgency by warning about suspicious login activity and pressures the user to click the “Change Password” button. Such links usually redirect users to fake login pages that steal usernames and passwords.

- **Possible Threats**

- Credential theft
- Unauthorized account access
- Identity theft
- Account takeover
- Personal information compromise

- **Prevention Guideline**

- Verify sender email domains carefully
- Avoid clicking password reset links from suspicious emails
- Visit official websites directly through the browser
- Enable two-factor authentication
- Report phishing emails immediately
- Check URLs carefully before entering credentials

Correct! This email used a look-alike URL.

This is almost identical to an attack used to successfully hack politicians' emails. Always be sure to check URLs carefully!

Show me



Google <no-reply@google.support>
to me ▾

3:13 PM

The sender address "google.support" isn't used.

Next

So

Hi,
Someone just used your password to try to sign in to your Google Account.

Information:
Saturday, May 9, 2026, 3:13:21 PM GMT+05:30
Slatina, Romania
Firefox browser

Google stopped this sign-in attempt. You should change your password immediately

CHANGE PASSWORD

Best,
The Mail Team

CONCLUSION

Phishing attacks remain one of the most common and dangerous cybersecurity threats affecting individuals and organizations worldwide. Through this task, various phishing techniques such as fake sender domains, urgent security alerts, OTP requests, and social engineering tactics were analyzed and identified.

This report helped improve understanding of phishing detection methods, cybersecurity awareness, and safe email handling practices. By carefully verifying sender information, suspicious links, and authentication requests, users can reduce the risk of phishing attacks and protect sensitive information from cybercriminals.